

REST ASSURED



HIDEAWAY COLONEL BATTYE'S RETREAT

As hideaways go, Colonel Battye's Rest House has been a well-kept secret for decades and few tourists know of this Raj-era bungalow in the hills of Himachal Pradesh. Not much has changed at the rest house, which started off in the 1920s as a camp site for Colonel B.C. Battye, an intrepid British engineer who designed and built north India's first hydel-power project in Himachal Pradesh.

Nestling 6,000 ft high in the mighty Dhauladhar mountain range, it is a two-hour scenic drive away from Palampur and

is approachable only by a one-km trek. Visitors require a permit from the Punjab State Electricity Board to stay at the rest house, for an extremely modest daily rent of Rs 200.

"It's a perfect place to relax or meditate," says Dalip Singh, the care taker. Bear and leopard sightings are not uncommon in the area and guests can also go mountain trekking or trout-fishing. Those looking for the perfect hideaway in the hills, can't do much better than the Battye rest house. *by Ramesh Vinayak*

THIS IS A SPECIAL PLACE, STRAIGHT OUT OF A HIMALAYAN ADVENTURE STORY
BY JIM CORBETT.

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